

# **BEYOND THE KINGDOM**

Episode #0009

Air Date: Thursday, January 13, 2005

Prod. #BTK-0009

Story Day: Thursday, January 13, 2005 (3:07 AM - 10:46 PM  
EST)

Teleplay by the Beyond the Kingdom Writers' Room  
Final Shooting Script

CAST OF CHARACTERS – EPISODE #0009

(ages as of Thursday, January 13, 2005)

THE DONOHUES: SIMONE TOUSSAINT DONOHUE (94) · VICTOR DONOHUE (68) · JOAN DONOHUE (66)

THE OLSONS: DR. PETER OLSON (45) · MARTIN OLSON (23) · MALLORY OLSON (19)

THE BULLOCKS: ROBERT BULLOCK (45) · NATASHA DONOHUE BULLOCK (43) · CHIEF ELXA BULLOCK JACKSON (24) · DET. JEREMY JACKSON (24) · MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (23) · GRACE BULLOCK (20)

THE SMILLEYS: LUCIUS SMILLEY (55) · VIVIENNE SMILLEY (49) · DESMOND SMILLEY (48) · ESTHER SMILLEY (22) · QUENTIN SMILLEY (21)

THE BAKERS: CURTIS BAKER (50) · GLORIA BAKER (48)

THE CHILDREN: LYRIC SOLACE BAKER (2)

THE CIRCLE: AMOND BAKER (22) · ARIANNA CUMMINGS (22) · HARMONY DIVINE (22)

THE SEVEN: KEISHA "GHOST" LATTIMORE (25) · ROMAN GAINES (28) · DOLORES "MAMA DEE" WHITFIELD (54)

RECURRING: INVESTIGATOR CARLA MIMS (47) · DEPUTY CHIEF WARREN HUGHES (46) · SPECIAL AGENT KATHLEEN "KATE" DOYLE (by phone) · CELESTE VAUGHN (24) · CAMILLE RHODES (38) · SILAS MERRIWEATHER (57) · THADDEUS CROWE (40)

DAY PLAYERS: DEPUTY CHIEFS TOLBERT, KEMP, WASHINGTON & ALBRIGHT · WBKG ANCHOR (on TV) · KEYONNA (7) · DEANDRE (9) · NURSE TONYA · PROCESS SERVER · GEORGIA DMV RECORDS CLERK (by phone) · NATHANIEL GREER (by phone) · CLEO (Simone's maid)

MENTIONED, NOT SEEN: Dr. Miriam Kessler · Winston Fairley · Teddy Merriweather (on security video) · Stanley (Gloria's lawyer) · the person on the other end of Martin's call · Jasmine Olson (Washington) · Alvin Donohue (Miami)

FADE IN:

TEASER

**1 INT. THE OLSON ESTATE – THE FRONT FOYER – NIGHT**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 3:07 AM EST*

Darkness. The grandfather clock ticks. Its hands say seven minutes past three.

The front door opens as quietly as a front door on West Paces Ferry can open. Mallory slips in, heels dangling from one hand, a Velvet staff hoodie over her jumpsuit. She eases the door shut. She turns.

The lamp on the hall table clicks on.

Peter sits on the bottom step of the staircase, exactly where he was at eleven forty-four. He's still in the cashmere sweater. He looks like he hasn't moved.

MALLORY  
(frozen)  
Daddy.

PETER  
(quietly)  
It's three o'clock.

MALLORY  
I know.

PETER  
You said midnight.

MALLORY  
I know. I texted Grace to—

PETER  
Grace called me at  
twelve-fifteen. She was crying.  
She said you told her to cover  
for you, and she couldn't lie to  
me, because I was the one who  
taught her to ride a bike.

Mallory closes her eyes.

MALLORY  
Daddy, I'm sorry. Nothing  
happened. I swear to God. We sat  
on a roof and talked.

PETER  
For three hours.

MALLORY  
(beat)  
He talks a lot.

Peter almost smiles. It doesn't take.

PETER  
Who is he?

MALLORY  
The DJ.

PETER  
What's his name?

MALLORY  
(beat)  
Q.

PETER  
Q what?

MALLORY  
He wouldn't say.

Peter stands up slowly. He walks to her. He takes the heels out of her hand and sets them on the hall table.

PETER  
Mallory. Listen to me.  
(beat)  
A man who won't tell you his name has a reason.

MALLORY  
Maybe his reason is his family.  
Maybe he's tired of being somebody's son. You don't know what that's like.

PETER  
(beat, very quietly)  
Don't I?

She looks at her father. His eyes are red. It isn't anger.

MALLORY  
(softly)  
You were scared.

PETER

I'm a surgeon. I've spent twenty years sewing up what happens to people at three o'clock in the morning.

(beat)

I was terrified.

She puts her arms around him. He holds on, hard.

PETER (CONT'D)

(into her hair)

Next time, you call me. I'll come get you. I don't care where you are. I don't care who he is.

MALLORY

Okay.

PETER

Promise.

MALLORY

I promise.

He lets her go. He kisses her forehead.

PETER

Go to bed. Your mother lands at ten-forty tomorrow, and if she finds out about this, we'll both need a surgeon.

Mallory laughs, wet. She picks up her shoes and runs up the stairs.

Peter stands alone in the foyer. He turns off the lamp.

In the dark, his cell phone lights up on the hall table. One missed call. +52 998.

He looks at it. He doesn't touch it.

CUT TO:

**2 INT. THE DOWAGER HOUSE – THE MORNING PARLOR – MORNING**  
*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 7:34 AM EST*

The pale-yellow parlor. On the round table, beside the silver coffee service, a small round cake on a crystal stand. White buttercream. Piped in blue icing: "7."

Simone sits at the table in lavender, beaming. Joan sits beside her in a gray suit and the everyday pearls. The Washington pearls are gone.

The door opens. Victor walks in, in a navy suit, freshly shaved. He stops. He looks at the cake.

VICTOR  
(flat)  
Mother.

SIMONE  
(delighted)  
Seven! A new record!

VICTOR  
You had a cake made.

SIMONE  
Cleo made it. I supervised. Sit down and eat your cake, Victor, you've earned it.

He sits. Cleo appears, cuts a slice, and sets it in front of him with great ceremony. He looks at Joan.

VICTOR  
Did you know about this?

JOAN  
(sipping her coffee)  
I suggested the number.

Victor picks up his fork. He eats a bite of cake at seven-thirty in the morning with enormous dignity.

VICTOR  
(chewing)  
It's very good, Cleo.

CLEO  
Thank you, sir. Welcome home, sir.

She goes. Simone refills her own cup.

SIMONE  
Tonight you sleep in your bed.

VICTOR  
So I'm told.

SIMONE

And you'll stop calling mayors.

VICTOR

(beat)

I'll stop calling mayors about my granddaughter.

JOAN

Victor.

VICTOR

That's the best I can do, Joan.  
I'm sixty-eight years old. The  
mayor is a phone call away. She's  
always been a phone call away.

Joan and Simone exchange a look. Simone lets it pass.

SIMONE

(lightly)

The Smilley girl wrote to me.

Victor's fork stops.

VICTOR

Esther Smilley?

SIMONE

A thank-you note. For my  
invitation. Delivered by hand,  
yesterday morning, before eight.  
Her man wouldn't wait for an  
answer.

VICTOR

What did she say?

SIMONE

(beat, sipping)

That it was the opposite.

VICTOR

The opposite of what?

SIMONE

(smiling into her cup)

That's the part she didn't say.

Victor looks at his mother. Ninety-four years old, pleased with herself, a step ahead of every person at the table.

VICTOR

Mother. What are you doing?

SIMONE

Eating cake. With my son. On the morning he comes home.

(beat)

Eat yours, Victor. You're going to need your strength. Your granddaughter's having a very big day.

CUT TO:

**3 INT. CITY HALL EAST – APD HEADQUARTERS – CHIEF'S  
CONFERENCE ROOM – DAY**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 9:00 AM EST*

A windowless conference room. A long table, a whiteboard, a coffee urn, and a flag in the corner. The blinds on the glass door are shut.

Elxa sits at the head of the table in full uniform. Jeremy sits at her right with a legal pad.

Around the table, the four DEPUTY CHIEFS: TOLBERT (50s, heavy, rumpled), KEMP (40s, bald, precise), WASHINGTON (50s, a woman with reading glasses on a chain), and ALBRIGHT (40s, a white man with a mustache). And at the foot of the table, directly opposite Elxa, Hughes.

In front of each of them, a manila folder: CONFIDENTIAL – COMMAND STAFF – BLACKWATER TASK FORCE – EYES ONLY. Each has a name typed on the tab.

ELXA

Good morning. Thank you for being here. I know the Council kept you late yesterday.

(beat, a glance at  
Hughes)

Some of you longer than others.

A few small smiles around the table. Hughes doesn't smile.

ELXA (CONT'D)

Everything the Blackwater Task Force has as of this morning is in front of you. Nine pages. Read it here. It doesn't leave this room. The folders stay on the table when you go.

TOLBERT  
(opening his)  
We can't take notes?

ELXA  
You can take notes, Deputy Chief.  
In your head.

They open their folders. The only sound is pages turning.

Elxa watches them read. She doesn't look at Hughes. She doesn't have to. Jeremy does it for her, without lifting his eyes from his legal pad.

Page one. Page two. Page five.

Page six.

Tolbert reads his page six. His eyebrows go up: "a second, prepaid cell phone."

Kemp reads his: "a partial print." He nods once, satisfied.

Washington reads hers: "a red sedan." She makes a small mark on the page with her fingernail.

Albright reads his: "the widow hired a PI." He frowns.

Hughes reads page six.

INSERT – HUGHES'S PAGE SIX: "The Chief believes the coin recovered at Piedmont Park is a FAKE..."

He reads it twice. A small muscle moves in his jaw. That's all.

He turns to page seven.

ELXA  
(evenly)  
Questions?

KEMP  
The partial print. Is it in AFIS?

ELXA  
Running now.

WASHINGTON  
The red sedan. Do we have a plate?

ELXA  
Partial. We're working it.

HUGHES  
(pleasantly, closing  
his folder)  
Chief. Page six.

The room quiets.

HUGHES (CONT'D)  
Your "assessment." I'd like to  
understand it. You don't believe  
the Blackwater Syndicate killed  
these men?

Elxa holds his eyes down the length of the table.

ELXA  
I believe what the evidence tells  
me, Deputy Chief. When it tells  
me something new, I'll believe  
that instead.

HUGHES  
And if the press asks?

ELXA  
(beat)  
The press won't ask. Because  
nobody at this table is going to  
tell them.

A long beat. Hughes smiles.

HUGHES  
Of course not.

ELXA  
(standing)  
Thank you. Folders stay on the  
table.

The deputy chiefs stand, leave their folders, and file  
out. Hughes is last. He stops at the door.

HUGHES  
Good meeting, Chief.

ELXA  
Thank you, Warren.

He goes. The door closes.

Elxa looks at the clock on the wall. 9:41 AM.

JEREMY  
(quietly)  
How long?

ELXA  
(sitting down, picking  
up her coffee)  
If it's him?  
(beat)  
Less than an hour.

SMASH CUT TO:

MAIN TITLES — "KINGDOM"



**ACT ONE****4 INT. CITY HALL EAST – APD HEADQUARTERS – DEPUTY CHIEF  
HUGHES'S OFFICE – DAY**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 9:52 AM EST*

A real office, with windows: plaques, a signed photo of Hughes with former Chief Harold Jackson, a framed 1988 Atlanta Journal front page ("COP SAVES BABY FROM HOLLYWOOD RD. BLAZE"), and a golf putter in the corner.

Hughes closes the door behind him. He locks it.

He stands at the window for a moment, looking down at Ponce de Leon Avenue.

Then he takes a flip phone out of his inside jacket pocket. Not the department BlackBerry on his belt. His own.

He dials a number from memory.

HUGHES  
(into phone, low)  
It's me.  
(beat)  
You didn't get this from me.  
(beat)  
The Chief doesn't think  
Blackwater did it. She thinks the  
coin's a fake. A copycat. She  
told the command staff this  
morning. In writing.  
(listening)  
No. Page six. "Chief's  
assessment."  
(beat)  
Because the city deserves to know  
their new Chief thinks the most  
dangerous gang in the South is  
being framed.  
(beat)  
Run it at noon.

He hangs up. He stands there, holding the phone. For a moment he looks like a man who's just done something he'll regret.

Then he looks at the 1988 front page on his wall. The young cop with the baby in his arms.

HUGHES (CONT'D)  
(quietly, to the  
photograph)  
Twenty-five years.

He puts the phone back in his pocket.

CUT TO:

**5 INT. CITY HALL EAST — APD HEADQUARTERS — CHIEF'S  
OFFICE — DAY**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 — 10:04 AM EST*

Elxa sits behind her desk with her arms folded. Jeremy stands beside her. Both watch the small TV on the filing cabinet. WBKG.

The morning show's cooking segment, a chef flipping crêpes, cuts abruptly to a red graphic: "BREAKING NEWS."

WBKG ANCHOR (ON TV)  
We interrupt this program with a  
Channel 8 exclusive. Sources  
inside the Atlanta Police  
Department tell Channel 8 that  
Chief Elxa Jackson privately  
believes the black onyx coins  
found with two murder victims  
this month are FAKES.

Jeremy exhales.

WBKG ANCHOR (ON TV) (CONT'D)  
According to a confidential  
command-staff document, the Chief  
believes the killings may be the  
work of a third party posing as  
the so-called Blackwater  
Syndicate. APD has not responded  
to our request for comment.

The graphic: "SOURCES: CHIEF BELIEVES 'BLACKWATER' COIN IS  
A FAKE."

Elxa watches it without moving.

ELXA  
(quietly)  
Page six.

JEREMY

Twenty-three minutes after he  
walked out of the room.

ELXA

He didn't even wait for noon.

JEREMY

(beat)

Somebody at WBKG couldn't.

Elxa picks up the remote. She turns off the TV.

She sits in silence for a long moment.

JEREMY (CONT'D)

(carefully)

Elx. Do you want me to get his  
badge?

ELXA

(beat)

No.

JEREMY

No?

ELXA

Not today.

Jeremy stares at her.

JEREMY

He just leaked a confidential  
document on live television.

ELXA

He leaked a true document on live  
television. The only true one.

(beat)

If I fire him today, I lose the  
only microphone I've got that I  
know is plugged in. Tomorrow,  
somebody else leaks, and I don't  
know who.

(beat)

If I keep him, I decide what goes  
into the microphone.

Jeremy looks at his wife for a long moment. Slowly, he  
starts to smile.

JEREMY

You're going to feed him.

ELXA

I'm going to feed him.

JEREMY

(beat)

My father would say that's cold.

ELXA

Your father would say that's a closed door and a pension. I'm keeping both of my promises.

Her desk phone RINGS. She glances at the display. FBI – ATLANTA. She picks up.

ELXA (CONT'D)

(into phone)

Jackson.

DOYLE (V.O.)

(filtered, dry)

I read it in the paper. Well, I watched it on TV. Between the crêpes.

ELXA

I told you you would.

DOYLE (V.O.)

(beat)

So you caught your mole.

ELXA

I caught my mole.

DOYLE (V.O.)

And?

ELXA

And he's staying right where he is.

A pause on the line.

DOYLE (V.O.)

(slowly)

Chief. That's either the dumbest thing I've ever heard a cop say or the smartest.

ELXA

(beat)

Call me in a month and I'll tell  
you which.

She hangs up. Jeremy is grinning outright now.

JEREMY

She likes you.

ELXA

(picking up a file)

Nobody likes me, Jeremy. They  
respect me, and it'll do.

CUT TO:

**6 INT. DONOHUE TOWER — MARTIN'S OFFICE — 86TH FLOOR —  
DAY**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 — 10:19 AM EST*

Black glass. The white orchid. On the bank of four TVs,  
WBKG loops the red graphic: "SOURCES: CHIEF BELIEVES  
'BLACKWATER' COIN IS A FAKE."

Martin stands in front of the screen with his hands in his  
pockets. He's perfectly still. For once, he isn't pleased.

He crosses to his desk. He unlocks the drawer. He takes  
out the black phone with no display.

He dials a long number. Not international this time.  
Local.

He waits. Then:

MARTIN

(into phone, very calm)

Turn on Channel Eight.

(beat)

Yes. That.

(listening)

She knows it's a fake. She knew  
last week. And now the whole city  
knows she knows.

(listening)

No. It doesn't change anything.  
It changes the story.

(beat)

Two dead men who don't matter to  
anybody north of I-20. A deacon  
and a loan shark. The papers were

bored by Monday.  
(beat)  
The city believes what it's  
afraid of. And right now it isn't  
afraid enough.  
(listening, then, with  
quiet precision)  
Then we give them something they  
can't call fake.  
(beat)  
I'll bring the details tomorrow  
night. Same place. Quarter to  
twelve.  
(beat)  
No. Not a deacon this time.

He hangs up. He puts the phone back in the drawer and  
locks it.

He turns back to the TV. The graphic is still there. Under  
it, a still photo: Elxa at her swearing-in, hand raised,  
four stars on her collar.

MARTIN (CONT'D)  
(softly, to the screen)  
Clever girl.  
(beat)  
Too clever for your own good,  
cousin.

He turns off the TV.

CUT TO:

**7 INT. KEEL & ASSOCIATES REALTY — BUCKHEAD — HARMONY'S  
CUBICLE — DAY**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 — 11:08 AM EST*

Harmony at her cubicle by the restroom, in a new charcoal  
suit, on the phone with a Smilley acquisitions binder open  
in front of her.

HARMONY  
(into phone)  
—no, the city owns the three  
south lots outright. I need the  
probate docket on the Reese  
estate. The heirs in Detroit—yes.  
Thank you. Call me back.

She hangs up. A PROCESS SERVER (50s), in a Braves  
windbreaker, is standing at her cubicle wall holding a

thick envelope.

PROCESS SERVER  
Harmony Divine?

HARMONY  
(warily)  
Who's asking?

PROCESS SERVER  
(handing it over)  
You've been served, ma'am. Have a  
nice day.

He's gone before she can say anything. Misty, three  
cubicles down, watches over the partition with naked  
delight.

Harmony looks at the envelope. FULTON COUNTY SUPERIOR  
COURT – FAMILY DIVISION.

She tears it open. Her eyes race down the first page.

INSERT – THE ORDER: "IN RE: LYRIC SOLACE BAKER, A MINOR  
CHILD. PETITION FOR GRANDPARENT VISITATION, GLORIA A.  
BAKER, PETITIONER... ORDER SETTING HEARING: MONDAY, MARCH  
14, 2005, 9:00 A.M.... FURTHER ORDERED that a family  
evaluation be conducted by court-appointed evaluator DR.  
MIRIAM KESSLER, PH.D., who shall interview the child's  
parents, the petitioner, and the child..."

Harmony reads it once. Then again. Her hand is shaking.

She grabs her cell phone. She dials. It rings once.

AMOND (V.O.)  
(filtered, surprised)  
Harmony?

HARMONY  
(low, furious)  
You did this.

INTERCUT WITH:

**INT. BSI TOWER – AMOND'S OFFICE – 58TH FLOOR – CONTINUOUS**

A big office down the hall from Marc's: modern, spare, a  
view of Midtown. A framed photo of Lyric on the pony on  
the credenza. Amond stands at his desk in shirtsleeves.

AMOND

Did what?

HARMONY

I just got served. At my desk. In front of the whole office. A hearing. March fourteenth. And a family evaluation. A court psychologist is going to come to my house and watch me feed my daughter.

AMOND

(stunned)

Harmony, I didn't—

HARMONY

You sent flowers Tuesday night. Peonies. "Proud of you."

(beat)

And Thursday morning I get served.

AMOND

I didn't know. I swear to God, Harmony, I didn't know anything about this.

HARMONY

Your mother's name is on it.

AMOND

My mother told her lawyer not to file anything. Tuesday night. I know she did. My father told me.

HARMONY

Then why am I holding it?

A beat. Amond has no answer.

HARMONY (CONT'D)

(her voice breaking)

One Sunday a month. That's what she offered. Like my daughter's a timeshare.

(beat)

Tell your mother the answer is no. Not "not yet." No.

AMOND

Harmony—

HARMONY

And don't send me any more  
flowers.

She hangs up.

In his office, Amond stands holding the dead phone. He  
looks at the photo of Lyric on the pony.

He grabs his coat.

FADE OUT.



## ACT TWO

**8 INT. THE BAKER HOME – 214 MAGNOLIA TERRACE – KITCHEN – DAY**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 12:21 PM EST*

The Baker kitchen at lunchtime. Gloria, in a cardigan, is arranging African violets on the windowsill. Curtis sits at the table in scrubs, eating a sandwich between shifts.

The back door BANGS open. Amond comes in with the court papers in his hand, still in his coat.

GLORIA  
(delighted)  
Baby! You never come home for lunch—

AMOND  
(holding up the papers)  
Mama. What is this?

Gloria sees the court seal. Her face falls.

GLORIA  
Where did you get that?

AMOND  
Harmony's lawyer faxed it to mine an hour ago. Harmony got served at her desk. In front of her whole office. A hearing. March fourteenth. And a court psychologist.  
(beat)  
She called me. She thinks I did it.

GLORIA  
(taking the papers, reading, horrified)  
I told Stanley not to file anything. Tuesday night. I called him from this kitchen. Your father was sitting right there.

CURTIS  
(quietly, setting down his sandwich)  
Glo.

GLORIA

I did, Curtis. You heard me.

CURTIS

I heard you. Tuesday.

(beat)

Last Thursday you told him to request a hearing. The day Harmony said "not yet." You were so angry you called him from the car.

Gloria stops.

CURTIS (CONT'D)

He filed the request last Thursday. The court set the date this week. That's all this is. The court doing what you asked it to do a week ago.

GLORIA

(sinking into a chair)

Oh, Lord.

AMOND

(beat)

So you did do it.

GLORIA

I did it last week. I undid it Tuesday. I didn't know you can't undo a court.

CURTIS

You can. You withdraw the petition.

Gloria looks up at her husband. Then at her son.

GLORIA

(beat)

No.

AMOND

Mama.

GLORIA

No, Amond. I'm not withdrawing it. I'm sorry she found out at her desk. I'm sorry about that. I'll write her a letter and say so.

(beat)  
But I'm not giving up the only  
way I have of seeing my  
granddaughter. She's had two  
years to let me in. She let me in  
eleven times.

AMOND  
She offered—

GLORIA  
She offered nothing. I offered  
one Sunday a month, and she said  
"not yet." And this morning, I  
hear, she said no.

AMOND  
(beat)  
She said no.

GLORIA  
Then a judge can decide.

A heavy silence. Curtis looks at his wife for a long  
moment.

CURTIS  
(quietly)  
Glo. When Amond was two, my  
mother wanted him every Sunday.  
Remember what you said to her?

Gloria doesn't answer.

CURTIS (CONT'D)  
You said, "Mrs. Baker, with  
respect, you'll see him when I  
say you'll see him, and not one  
day before, and if you don't like  
it, you can take it up with  
Jesus."

GLORIA  
(stung)  
That was different.

CURTIS  
It was exactly the same. You were  
twenty-seven and scared, and my  
mother had an opinion about  
everything you did.  
(beat)  
Harmony's twenty-two.

Gloria stares at him. Her eyes fill.

GLORIA  
(barely)  
I just want to hold her.

AMOND  
(softening, crouching  
beside her chair)  
I know, Mama.

GLORIA  
(touching his face)  
You look just like her. Did you  
know that? She has your face.

AMOND  
(beat)  
I know.

Gloria looks at the court papers in her lap.

GLORIA  
I'll write the letter. The  
apology.  
(beat)  
But the petition stays.

Amond stands. He looks at his father. Curtis shakes his  
head slightly. Not today.

AMOND  
(quietly)  
Okay, Mama.

He goes out the back door. Curtis picks up his sandwich  
and doesn't eat it.

CUT TO:

**9 INT. CHILDREN'S HEALTHCARE OF ATLANTA AT EGLESTON –  
PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY PLAYROOM – DAY**  
*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 1:12 PM EST*

The playroom. Paper snowflakes. The fish tank. Marc on the  
alphabet rug in shirtsleeves with a second hand-bound  
book: THE DINOSAUR PRINCESS AND THE DRAGON. The cover: the  
same purple grape in a tiara, now next to a green blob  
with wings.

Keyonna, in pink pajamas, leans against his knee. DeAndre,  
with his IV pole, sits a skeptical foot away. Nurse Tonya

leans in the doorway.

MARC

Okay. Chapter two. Before we start, the Princess needs a name for the dragon. Keyonna.

KEYONNA

(ready, very serious)

Gorgeous.

Marc's mouth opens. Closes.

MARC

(beat)

Gorgeous?

KEYONNA

You said it on the phone. In the hallway. Before Christmas. "Hey, Gorgeous." You sounded happy.

(beat)

The dragon should sound happy.

Nurse Tonya covers her mouth.

MARC

(recovering, laughing)

That was my great-grandmother. She's ninety-four.

DEANDRE

You call your great-grandma Gorgeous?

MARC

Every Monday.

DEANDRE

(grudging)

That's kind of cool.

MARC

(to Keyonna, solemnly,  
writing on the title  
page with a marker)

The dragon's name is Gorgeous.  
And she's ninety-four years old.  
And she's the smartest dragon in  
the Kingdom of Snacks.

KEYONNA

(beaming)

Yes.

Marc opens the book. His phone buzzes in his pocket.  
AMOND. He lets it go to voicemail.

MARC  
(reading, big voice)  
"One morning, the Dinosaur  
Princess woke up and found a  
dragon sitting on her roof,  
eating all the chimneys—"

It buzzes again. AMOND. Then a text.

INSERT — THE TEXT: "911. not blackwater. harmony."

Marc closes the book gently.

MARC (CONT'D)  
(to the kids)  
Five minutes. Nobody tell  
Gorgeous anything without me.

**10 INT. EGLESTON — THE HALLWAY OUTSIDE THE PLAYROOM —  
CONTINUOUS**

Marc walks and calls, phone to his ear.

MARC  
(into phone)  
Talk.

AMOND (V.O.)  
(filtered, in his car)  
She got served. At her desk.  
Mama's petition. A hearing in  
March and a court psychologist.  
Harmony called me and said, "You  
did this." Then she told me not  
to send any more flowers.

MARC  
Did you do it?

AMOND (V.O.)  
No! Mama did it last week when  
Harmony said "not yet." Then she  
changed her mind Tuesday. But you  
can't change a court's mind.  
(beat)  
And now Mama won't withdraw it.  
She says a judge can decide.

Marc stops at the window at the end of the hall. Outside, a little boy in a wheelchair is being pushed around the courtyard by his father.

MARC

(beat)

Mond. Your mother's not the villain.

AMOND (V.O.)

I know she's not the villain.  
She's my MOTHER.

MARC

She's a grandmother who's held  
her granddaughter eleven times.  
Everybody in this story is right,  
and that's what makes it hard.

AMOND (V.O.)

(beat)

So what do I do?

MARC

You go to Harmony's door tonight.  
Not with flowers. Not with  
lawyers. With something of  
Lyric's.

(beat)

And you tell her the truth. You  
didn't know. Your mother made a  
mistake. And you're not going to  
fight her in court. Whatever your  
mother does.

AMOND (V.O.)

(beat)

I'm not?

MARC

Are you?

AMOND (V.O.)

(long beat)

No.

MARC

Then tell her.

AMOND (V.O.)

(beat)

When did you get good at this?

MARC  
(watching the boy in  
the courtyard)  
I read a lot of children's books.

He hangs up. He stands at the window a moment.

Then he goes back to the playroom, to a dragon named  
Gorgeous.

CUT TO:

**11 INT. THE OLSON ESTATE – THE CATERING KITCHEN – DAY**  
*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 1:53 PM EST*

The stainless-steel kitchen. A double boiler bubbling with  
batch two of the rose balm. Amber glass sample jars lined  
up on the counter with handwritten labels.

Mallory, in safety goggles and an oversized sweater, eyes  
shadowed from three hours of sleep, stirs. Grace sits on  
the counter in sweats and sunglasses, holding a coffee,  
glaring.

GRACE  
You. Left. Me.

MALLORY  
I told you to go.

GRACE  
You TEXTED me to go. From a ROOF.  
With a MAN.

MALLORY  
He's a DJ.

GRACE  
Named Q!

MALLORY  
So?

GRACE  
(taking off her  
sunglasses)  
Mallory Simone Olson. "Q" is not  
a name. "Q" is a serial-killer  
name. "Q" is what they call the  
guy on Law and Order who keeps  
body parts in a freezer.

MALLORY  
(laughing despite  
herself)  
He doesn't keep body parts in a  
freezer.

GRACE  
How do you KNOW? You don't know  
his LAST NAME.

MALLORY  
I know he's from Chicago. The  
part with the lake.

GRACE  
(beat)  
That's all of Chicago.

MALLORY  
That's what I said!

Grace hops off the counter and comes around to the double  
boiler. She looks at her cousin's face. Really looks.

GRACE  
(slowly)  
Oh no.

MALLORY  
What?

GRACE  
You're glowing.

MALLORY  
I'm tired.

GRACE  
You're tired AND glowing. That's  
the worst combination. That's how  
Mama looked in the pictures from  
her honeymoon.

MALLORY  
(stirring, pink)  
Nothing happened, Grace.

GRACE  
Did he kiss you?

MALLORY  
No.

GRACE

Did he TRY?

MALLORY

(beat)

No.

(beat)

He asked if he could walk me to the cab. And then he asked if he could call me. And then he wrote his number on my hand because I wouldn't give him mine.

She holds up her left hand. On the palm, faded Sharpie: a 312 number and a single letter. Q.

GRACE

(staring)

He wrote it on your HAND.

MALLORY

I didn't wash it.

GRACE

(beat)

Oh, you're in trouble.

(beat, softer)

Did Uncle Peter kill you?

MALLORY

(the smile fading)

No. He was waiting on the stairs.

He didn't yell. He just...

(beat)

He looked scared, Gracie. Daddy never looks scared. He sews people's faces back together.

(beat)

And he's been getting phone calls from Mexico. He doesn't answer them.

GRACE

Mexico?

MALLORY

A 998 number. I looked it up. Cancún.

Grace takes that in.

GRACE

Maybe it's a patient.

MALLORY  
(stirring slowly)  
That's what he said.

A beat. The rose balm bubbles. Grace sniffs it.

GRACE  
(gently changing the  
subject)  
It's better than batch one.

MALLORY  
(looking up)  
It is?

GRACE  
It smells like the Dowager House  
now. Like Sunday.  
(beat)  
Call him.

MALLORY  
Who?

GRACE  
The serial killer. Call him. Just  
don't go on any more roofs  
without telling me first. I'm  
your cousin. I'm legally  
obligated to be on the next roof.

Mallory laughs. She looks at the number on her palm.

CUT TO:

**12 INT. FULTON COUNTY COURTHOUSE – DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S  
OFFICE – DAY**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 2:00 PM EST*

The DA's office. Arianna sits at her conference table, not behind her desk. Jacket on. Hands folded. Composed. She looks like a DA about to depose someone.

Carla sits across from her with a yellow legal pad, a pen, and her thermos. On the corkboard over Carla's shoulder, Dee grins down at both of them.

CARLA

Thank you for doing this, Madam District Attorney. I'm asking everybody on the Henderson list the same four questions. Word for word. You're first.

ARIANNA

That's the right way.

CARLA

(pen ready)

Question one. Were you a guest at the home of Dr. and Mrs. Walter Henderson, 3244 Northside Drive, on the night of December 31, 2001?

ARIANNA

Yes.

CARLA

(writing)

Question two. At approximately what time did you leave, and by what route did you drive?

ARIANNA

(evenly)

Around two. A little after. I took Northside south to West Paces Ferry and turned west, toward home.

CARLA

(writing)

South on Northside. Toward the curve.

ARIANNA

(beat)

Toward West Paces. Yes.

CARLA

You were driving.

ARIANNA

I was driving.

CARLA

The designated driver.

ARIANNA  
(a small smile)  
I told Bernadette Sinclair a lot  
of things at midnight.

Carla smiles too. She writes.

CARLA  
Question three.  
(beat, looking up, her  
voice exactly the same)  
Between approximately one-thirty  
and three o'clock that morning,  
did you see anyone walking on  
Northside Drive?

The office is very quiet. The radiator ticks.

Arianna holds Carla's eyes.

ARIANNA  
(beat)  
No.

CARLA  
(still looking at her)  
No one.

ARIANNA  
It was dark. There are no  
sidewalks on that stretch. There  
are no streetlights past the  
Hendersons' gate. I was watching  
the road.  
(beat)  
I didn't see anyone.

Carla holds her look a moment longer. Then she writes on  
the pad.

INSERT — THE LEGAL PAD, Carla's neat hand: "Q3 — 'No.'  
(2.5 sec.) Volunteered: dark, no sidewalks, no lights,  
watching road."

BACK TO SCENE

CARLA  
Question four. Is there anyone  
you believe I should speak with?

ARIANNA  
(beat)

The valets. They'd have seen every car that left and which way it turned. And the off-duty officers on the door.

CARLA

(writing)

That's what I'd say too.

(capping her pen)

That's it. Four questions. Thank you, Madam District Attorney.

ARIANNA

(standing)

That's it?

CARLA

(standing, gathering her thermos)

That's it. The same four for all two hundred and eleven.

(beat)

Most people take about ninety seconds. You took four minutes. But you're a lawyer. Lawyers answer the question and then the question after the question.

Arianna's smile doesn't change.

CARLA (CONT'D)

(at the door)

One more thing. Not a question. Just making conversation.

ARIANNA

Of course.

CARLA

(pleasantly)

That was a pretty silver dress. In Bernadette's picture.

(beat)

What were you driving back then? A girl your age, from your family. Something nice, I bet.

ARIANNA

(beat)

A Volvo. My father thought it was safe.

CARLA  
(nodding)  
Fathers do.  
(beat)  
Thank you again.

She goes. The door closes.

Arianna stands at the conference table. She doesn't sit down. She looks at the door.

Then, slowly, she turns and looks at Dee's photograph on the corkboard.

ARIANNA  
(barely a whisper)  
I'm sorry.

She says it to the photograph. Nobody else hears.

CUT TO:

**13 INT. CARLA'S BUICK — PARKED — FULTON COUNTY  
COURTHOUSE GARAGE — CONTINUOUS**  
*Thursday, January 13, 2005 — 2:09 PM EST*

The maroon Buick LeSabre in a concrete parking deck. Carla sits behind the wheel with the legal pad on her knee and a cell phone to her ear.

CARLA  
(into phone)  
Darlene. It's Carla Mims. I'm  
with the DA's office now.  
(listening)  
I know. I know. Retirement didn't  
take.  
(beat)  
Darlene, I need a title history.  
A Volvo. Registered in Fulton  
County to a Cummings.  
C-U-M-M-I-N-G-S. First name  
Arianna, or the father, Franklin.  
Probably a 2000 or 2001 model.  
(listening)  
I want to know what happened to  
it. Sold, traded, totaled.  
Whatever the state knows.  
(beat)  
How long?

GEORGIA DMV RECORDS CLERK (V.O.)

(filtered)

The old records are on the  
mainframe in the basement, hon.  
Ten days. Two weeks if Frank's  
out.

CARLA

Two weeks is fine.

(beat)

And Darlene. Keep it between us.  
It's probably nothing.

She hangs up. She looks at the legal pad on her knee. "Q3  
— 'No.' (2.5 sec.)"

She sits in the dim garage for a while.

CARLA (CONT'D)

(to herself)

It's probably nothing.

She starts the car.

FADE OUT.



## ACT THREE

**14 INT. SMILLEY TOWER – 71ST FLOOR – ESTHER'S OFFICE – DAY**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 3:06 PM EST*

The white office. Across Peachtree, Donohue Tower. Harmony paces in front of the curved glass wall holding the court order. Esther sits on the edge of her white desk, reading a copy.

HARMONY

—at my DESK, Esther. Misty Calloway watched the whole thing over the cubicle wall like it was the Super Bowl. And a psychologist. A court psychologist is going to sit in my living room and take notes on whether I cut Lyric's grapes right.

ESTHER

(reading)

Dr. Miriam Kessler.

HARMONY

You know her?

ESTHER

I know the type.

(setting the order down)

Harm. Stop pacing. You're wearing a hole in the carpet I haven't finished paying for.

Harmony stops. She drops into one of the white leather chairs.

HARMONY

I called him. I told him he did it.

ESTHER

Did he?

HARMONY

(beat)

He said he didn't know. He sounded like he didn't know.

ESTHER

(beat)

Then he probably didn't.

HARMONY

It's his mother's name on the paper.

ESTHER

Yes. And it's his mother's petition, and his mother's lawyer, and his mother's grandbaby.

(beat)

Harmony. Listen to me. For three years you've been fighting the Bakers in parking decks. With your hands. With your mouth. With me on the phone telling you to make them earn it.

HARMONY

You did say that.

ESTHER

I did. And I was right, and now I'm telling you something else.

(beat)

Let a judge say it.

HARMONY

(beat)

What?

ESTHER

Stop fighting them yourself. Let a judge look at you. A mother with a job, a clean house, a daughter who's happy and fed and loved and has a pony. And let a judge look at them. A grandmother who filed a petition on a toddler whose mother is looking for her missing brother.

(beat)

And then let the judge say it. Out loud. In a courtroom. Where it counts.

HARMONY

(slowly)

And if the judge says Gloria gets Sundays?

ESTHER

(beat)

Then Lyric gets a grandmother on Sundays.

(beat)

There are worse things, Harm. I had one.

Harmony looks at her. Esther looks back, calm.

HARMONY

(beat)

When did you get so wise?

ESTHER

I'm a mother of two.

(beat)

And I have a very good lawyer. You'll have him by five o'clock.

HARMONY

Esther—

ESTHER

Don't argue. Mr. Kincaid charges eight hundred dollars an hour, and he owes my father a favor from 1991. He's already read the file.

Harmony laughs, tearing up. She stands and hugs Esther hard.

HARMONY

(into her shoulder)

I don't know what I'd do without you.

ESTHER

(holding her, eyes closed)

You'll never have to find out.

Harmony pulls back, wiping her eyes. She picks up her things.

HARMONY

The Reese probate. I'll have it tomorrow.

ESTHER

Good. Go.

Harmony goes. The door closes.

Esther's face changes the instant it does. The warmth stays, but something harder comes up behind it.

The inner door to her private conference room opens. Crowe comes out. He's been waiting. He carries a thin manila envelope.

CROWE

Last night. The Ritz. Your uncle.

He lays four glossy photographs on the white desk, one after another. Drugstore prints from a disposable camera. Grainy but clear.

Desmond at the corner table with a cognac.

A young Black man in a charcoal overcoat sitting down across from him.

The two of them talking.

And later, near midnight, the two of them sitting by the fire, leaning toward each other.

ESTHER

(very quietly)

Who is he?

CROWE

Martin Donohue Olson.  
Twenty-three. Senior vice  
president at Donohue Global  
Holdings. Congresswoman Olson's  
son. The eldest grandchild of  
Victor Donohue.

(beat)

And, since 1996, the second-best  
grandson.

Esther picks up the last photograph. Martin's face in the firelight. Not smiling.

ESTHER

The one who didn't get the crown.

CROWE

Yes, ma'am.

ESTHER

(beat)

What were they talking about?

CROWE

My man couldn't hear. They talked for eleven minutes at nine. Then they sat on opposite ends of the room for nearly three hours.

(beat)

Then your uncle walked over and sat down again. They talked for eight minutes. Your uncle did most of the talking. Mr. Olson listened.

(beat)

My man says that at the end, Mr. Olson stopped smiling.

Esther sets the photograph down. She stares at it.

ESTHER

My uncle told Mr. Olson something.

CROWE

Yes, ma'am.

ESTHER

Something about me.

CROWE

(beat)

I don't know that, ma'am.

ESTHER

(evenly)

I do.

Silence. Across Peachtree, the Donohue crown catches the afternoon sun.

CROWE

What would you like me to do?

ESTHER

(beat)

Nothing.

CROWE

Ma'am?

ESTHER

If I confront my uncle, he'll know I'm watching. If I tell my father, it'll kill him.

(beat)

Keep a man in that bar every night my uncle's in it. And find out everything about Martin Olson that isn't on the DGH website.

CROWE

(beat)

And the CEO of BSI?

ESTHER

(sharply)

We've discussed that.

CROWE

Ma'am, if Mr. Olson is interested in you, and you've been to his cousin's gate twice—

ESTHER

(standing)

Thank you, Thaddeus.

He stops. He picks up the envelope, leaving the photographs.

CROWE

Yes, ma'am.

He goes. Esther stands alone with four photographs of her uncle and a stranger.

She picks up the one of Martin by the fire. She holds it up to the window, next to the Donohue crown across the street.

ESTHER

(softly)

What did he tell you?

CUT TO:

**15 INT. SMILLEY TOWER — 69TH FLOOR — DESMOND'S OFFICE — DAY**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 — 3:54 PM EST*

The minimalist office. The Basquiat. Desmond sits behind his desk reading the Wall Street Journal, tranquil.

The door opens without a knock. Quentin wanders in: sunglasses, a Velvet hoodie over a T-shirt, a coffee, sneakers that cost more than most cars' tires. He's been awake for about forty minutes.

QUENTIN

Dad. Your assistant said you wanted me. I thought somebody died.

DESMOND

(not looking up)  
Sit down, Quentin.

QUENTIN

(dropping into a chair,  
throwing a leg over the  
arm)  
Is this about the board meeting?  
I told Aunt Vivienne, I don't do  
mornings. My two votes are yours.  
Use them however you want.

DESMOND

(folding the paper)  
It's not about the board meeting.  
(beat)  
Where were you last night?

QUENTIN

Working.

DESMOND

Until three?

QUENTIN

The club closes at three, Dad.  
That's what "working" means when  
you're a DJ.

DESMOND

Your set ended at twelve-thirty.  
The manager told my assistant.

QUENTIN

(beat)  
Then I was working on something  
else.

DESMOND

(studying him)  
You're smiling.

QUENTIN

I'm always smiling.

DESMOND

You're never smiling before noon.

QUENTIN  
It's four o'clock.

DESMOND  
(beat)  
That's what I mean.

Quentin laughs. He takes off his sunglasses. His eyes are tired and happy.

QUENTIN  
Dad. It's nothing. I met  
somebody. We talked. That's it.

DESMOND  
Who?

QUENTIN  
(beat)  
Nobody you'd know.

DESMOND  
I know everybody.

QUENTIN  
(standing, putting the  
sunglasses back on)  
Then you'll find out on your own.  
You always do.

He heads for the door.

DESMOND  
Quentin.

Quentin stops.

DESMOND (CONT'D)  
(evenly)  
This city isn't Chicago. In  
Chicago, we were the only family  
that mattered. Here, there are  
two. And every girl in Buckhead  
is related to one of them.  
(beat)  
Be careful who you talk to until  
three in the morning.

Quentin looks at his father.

QUENTIN  
(beat)  
You too, Dad.

DESMOND

(beat)

What does that mean?

QUENTIN

(a small shrug)

Somebody at Velvet said they saw  
your car at the Ritz last night.  
Till midnight.

(beat)

You never stay anywhere till  
midnight.

He goes. The door closes.

Desmond sits very still. Then he picks up the Journal  
again.

He doesn't read it.

CUT TO:

**16 INT. WBKG CHANNEL 8 — NEWSROOM — CELESTE'S DESK — DAY**  
*Thursday, January 13, 2005 — 4:22 PM EST*

A busy local newsroom: rows of desks, a wall of monitors,  
producers shouting. On every screen, the red banner from  
this morning is still running: "SOURCES: CHIEF BELIEVES  
'BLACKWATER' COIN IS A FAKE."

Celeste sits at her desk, which is plastered with  
Post-its, in a camel turtleneck, with her phone to her  
ear. She's looking at the banner with visible irritation.

CELESTE

(into phone, low)

It wasn't my story. It came in on  
the desk line. Hank took it. He  
ran it at ten-oh-four without  
calling the Chief's office.

INTERCUT WITH:

**INT. DONOHUE TOWER — MARTIN'S OFFICE — 86TH FLOOR —**  
**CONTINUOUS**

Martin sits back in his leather chair, one ankle on his  
knee, looking out at Smilley Tower.

MARTIN

(pleasantly)

I didn't say it was your story. I said it was a good one.

CELESTE  
It's a leak. Leaks aren't stories. They're weather.

MARTIN  
(smiling)  
That's very good. You should put that on a mug.  
(beat)  
You didn't return my call yesterday.

CELESTE  
I was at lunch.

MARTIN  
With my cousin. South City Kitchen. He had the shrimp and grits. You stole a fried green tomato.

Celeste goes still.

CELESTE  
(beat)  
Are you having me followed, Martin?

MARTIN  
I'm having lunch reservations followed. It's a small city, Celeste. Everybody in Midtown saw you.  
(beat)  
How's your count going?

CELESTE  
(guarded)  
It's going.

MARTIN  
Three of seven Harlow defendants. Eleven of nineteen gambling cases. Four of four fire suits. Bullock and Associates.  
(beat)  
You told me you needed one more number.

CELESTE  
I'm working on it.

MARTIN  
Work on it in Savannah.

CELESTE  
(beat)  
Savannah?

MARTIN  
The Port of Savannah files a  
public record for every container  
that clears customs. The  
importer. The broker. And the  
customs attorney of record.  
(beat)  
Look at who the attorney of  
record is on the Donohue Shipping  
containers that came in from  
Durban last fall.

Celeste grabs a pen. She writes on a Post-it: "SAV. PORT –  
DURBAN – ATTY OF RECORD."

CELESTE  
(slowly)  
Why would you tell me that?  
That's your own family's shipping  
line.

MARTIN  
(beat)  
Because I believe in a free  
press.

CELESTE  
(dry)  
No, you don't.

MARTIN  
(laughing softly)  
No. I don't.  
(beat)  
But I believe in you, Celeste.  
And I believe my family is big  
enough to survive the truth.  
(beat)  
Some of it, anyway.

CELESTE  
(beat)  
And Marc?

MARTIN  
(pleasantly)  
Marc runs a security company.  
What would Marc have to do with a  
law firm's customs filings?

A pause. Celeste looks at the Post-it.

CELESTE  
I'm having dinner with him  
tomorrow night.

MARTIN  
Then have a lovely dinner. And  
don't talk about work. My cousin  
hates it when people talk about  
work.

He hangs up. He sits back and looks out at the Smilley  
crown.

In the newsroom, Celeste stares at the dead phone. Then  
she peels the Post-it off the desk and folds it into her  
wallet, behind her driver's license.

FADE OUT.



**ACT FOUR**

**17 INT. BELLE RIVE – NATASHA'S STUDY – DAY**  
*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 4:41 PM EST*

The peacock-blue study. Afternoon light. Natasha sits at the Louis XV writing desk in a camel suit, the phone at her ear, a legal pad in front of her.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
(filtered)  
Mrs. Bullock. I asked a friend in parking.

NATASHA  
Go on.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
Ms. Rhodes drives a black 2003 Jaguar XJ8. Georgia plates. It's registered to the firm.  
(beat)  
Every Thursday night since March of 2000, that car has entered the Colony Square parking garage in Midtown between seven-thirty and eight-thirty in the evening. It leaves between five-thirty and six the next morning.

Natasha writes: "COLONY SQ. – THURS. – 8 PM to 6 AM."

NATASHA  
Every Thursday.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
Almost every. She missed Thanksgiving. And three weeks in the summer of 2002.

NATASHA  
(beat)  
Robert and I went to Martha's Vineyard for three weeks in the summer of 2002.

A silence on the line.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
(carefully)  
Yes, ma'am.

NATASHA  
(evenly)  
And his car?

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
Mr. Bullock doesn't park in the  
garage, ma'am. Or if he does,  
it's not under his own name or  
his plates. I checked.

NATASHA  
He's careful.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
He's a defense attorney, ma'am.

NATASHA  
(beat)  
What's within walking distance of  
the Colony Square garage?

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
Three hotels. The Four Seasons on  
Fourteenth. The Colony Square  
Hotel, which is attached to the  
garage. And the Peachtree Midtown  
Plaza across the street.  
(beat)  
I don't have anybody inside any  
of them yet.

NATASHA  
Yet.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
Yet, ma'am.

Natasha looks at the legal pad. She looks at the calendar  
on her desk. Thursday, January 13.

NATASHA  
(quietly)  
It's Thursday.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)  
(beat)  
Yes, ma'am. Would you like me to  
put someone on the garage  
tonight?

A long pause. Natasha stands. She goes to the window and  
looks down at the empty motor court.

NATASHA

No.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)

Ma'am?

NATASHA

I'm not going to chase my husband through a parking garage on a Thursday night like a woman in a Lifetime movie, Nathaniel.

(beat)

When I go to Midtown, I'll know exactly which door to knock on. And I'll own the door.

NATHANIEL GREER (V.O.)

(beat)

Yes, Mrs. Bullock.

NATASHA

Find me the hotel. Take all the time you need. Just not too much.

She hangs up. She stands at the window.

In the leather datebook on her desk, under Thursday: "R. — late."

CUT TO:

**18 INT. BSI TOWER — 57TH FLOOR — "THE GHOST ROOM" — DUSK**  
*Thursday, January 13, 2005 — 5:36 PM EST*

Blue light. Server hum. Keisha in her chair. Marc leans over her shoulder. Roman stands behind them, arms folded, still in his coat.

On one monitor, WBKG's banner: "CHIEF BELIEVES 'BLACKWATER' COIN IS A FAKE."

On another: Hughes's personal cell phone records, in a column.

KEISHA

Nine fifty-two AM. Deputy Chief Warren Hughes's personal cell. Four minutes, eleven seconds. To the WBKG assignment desk.

(beat)

The meeting ended at nine forty-one. He made it eleven

minutes.

MARC  
(quietly)  
She got him.

KEISHA  
She got him clean. Five folders,  
five page sixes. I pulled the  
building's key-card log.  
Everybody else went back to their  
offices and made normal calls.  
Hughes locked his door.

MARC  
(almost to himself,  
proud)  
She set a canary trap on her  
first real week on the job and  
didn't tell a soul but her  
husband and her DA.

ROMAN  
And she didn't fire him.

MARC  
(a slow smile)  
No. She didn't.

KEISHA  
Why not?

MARC  
Because now she's got a  
microphone she controls. Every  
word she lets Hughes hear goes  
straight to WBKG. She can put  
anything she wants on the six  
o'clock news.  
(beat)  
That's not a mistake. That's a  
weapon.

ROMAN  
(dry)  
She's your sister.

MARC  
She's better than me. She doesn't  
have to lie to anybody to do it.

A beat. Keisha glances up at him.

MARC (CONT'D)  
Roman. The Waffle House.

ROMAN  
(stepping forward,  
handing Keisha a VHS  
tape)  
The manager's a deacon at  
Friendship Baptist. He's been  
robbed four times. He likes  
Blackwater. He gave me Monday's  
tape for two hundred dollars and  
a promise nobody would hurt his  
cook.

Keisha slides the VHS into a deck. The monitor flickers.  
Grainy black-and-white security footage from a camera  
mounted over a Waffle House register. Timestamp: 01/10/05  
12:14.

A booth by the window. Teddy Merriweather in a camel  
overcoat, facing the camera.

Across from him, back to the camera: a tall man in a dark  
canvas jacket and a baseball cap pulled low. Broad  
shoulders. Short hair at the nape. He sits perfectly  
straight, both hands flat on the table.

He never turns his head. Not once in the minute of footage  
Keisha fast-forwards through.

KEISHA  
(frustrated)  
He knew where the camera was.

ROMAN  
He picked the seat.

MARC  
(leaning closer)  
Look at his hands.

On the screen, the man's hands rest flat on the tabletop  
the whole time. Utterly still.

ROMAN  
(quietly)  
Military. Hands where everybody  
can see them, so nobody gets  
nervous. Back to the wall's what  
you want, but back to the  
camera's what you take when the  
wall's got a window.

KEISHA

Can you tell me anything?

ROMAN

Right-handed. Six-two, six-three.  
Hundred and ninety. Doesn't eat.  
Look, he ordered coffee and  
didn't touch it.

(beat)

And he paid in cash and left a  
tip. Exact change. Twenty  
percent.

MARC

(beat)

Professional.

ROMAN

Professional. And polite.

(beat)

The polite ones are the worst.

Marc straightens up. He looks at the frozen image: the  
back of a head, a cap, two hands flat on a Formica table.

MARC

Ghost. Johannesburg.

KEISHA

Tonight. One AM our time. Their  
office manager turns on the order  
computer at eight AM Joburg.

MARC

(beat)

Then by tomorrow, I want the name  
of whoever paid for those coins.

(beat)

And Roman. Pack a bag.

ROMAN

Where?

MARC

Savannah.

CUT TO:

**19 INT. RAVENHURST – LUCIUS'S STUDY – DUSK**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 6:04 PM EST*

The dark study. The fire. Portraits of Cornelius and young Odessa.

Lucius sits at his desk in his shirtsleeves. In front of him, the same stack of documents from Monday.

Vivienne stands at the fire with a glass of wine, watching.

Lucius picks up the heavy gold pen with his right hand. He holds it a moment. His hand is steady.

He signs.

A clean, strong, elegant signature. Lucius C. Smilley. The same one that's been on Smilley International's annual reports since 1987.

He stares at it. He signs the next page. And the next. Every one perfect.

LUCIUS  
(quietly)  
Vivienne.

VIVIENNE  
(setting down her  
glass)  
I see it.

LUCIUS  
(a disbelieving laugh)  
Look at that. Look at that.

He holds up his right hand. Steady as a surgeon's. He turns it over, back and forth, like a man who's found a lost ring.

LUCIUS (CONT'D)  
Harrington said I'd have good  
days.

VIVIENNE  
(crossing to him)  
He did.

LUCIUS  
He said I'd have good days that  
would make me think he was wrong.

VIVIENNE  
(beat)  
He did.

LUCIUS  
(looking up at her,  
eyes shining)  
He's wrong.

VIVIENNE  
(gently)  
Darling.

LUCIUS  
Let me have it. Just tonight. Let  
me have one night where he's  
wrong.

Vivienne looks at her husband. She takes his steady right  
hand in both of hers. She kisses the knuckles.

VIVIENNE  
(softly)  
Tonight he's wrong.

Lucius laughs. He pulls her down onto his knee like a man  
half his age. She laughs too, surprised.

For a moment they're just a husband and wife in a firelit  
room, laughing.

Then Vivienne turns her face into his shoulder so he can't  
see it.

Her eyes are full.

FADE OUT.



## ACT FIVE

**20 INT. CITY HALL EAST – APD HEADQUARTERS – CHIEF'S OFFICE – NIGHT**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 6:43 PM EST*

Elxa sits behind her desk. The WBKG banner has finally been replaced on the TV by the weather.

A knock. Hughes stands in the doorway, cap under his arm. His face is carefully neutral.

HUGHES

You wanted to see me, Chief.

ELXA

Come in, Warren. Close the door.  
Sit down.

He hesitates at "sit down." He's never been asked before. He closes the door and sits.

ELXA (CONT'D)

You saw the news this morning.

HUGHES

(evenly)

I did. Terrible. Somebody at that table has a big mouth.

ELXA

(beat)

Somebody does.

A long silence. Hughes holds her gaze. So does she.

HUGHES

Is there something you want to ask me, Chief?

ELXA

(pleasantly)

No.

HUGHES

(beat, thrown)

No?

ELXA

No. I want to give you something.

She slides a folder across the desk. The label reads: "FBI LIAISON – BLACKWATER TASK FORCE."

ELXA (CONT'D)

As of tomorrow, you're my liaison to the FBI's Operation Deep Water. Special Agent Kate Doyle. You'll sit in on their briefings. You'll carry our updates to them and theirs back to me.

(beat)

Everything that passes between this department and the Bureau goes through you.

Hughes stares at the folder. Then at her.

HUGHES

(slowly)

Why me?

ELXA

Because you have twenty-five years, Warren. And contacts I'll never have. And because you told the City Council yesterday you weren't in the loop.

(beat)

Now you're the loop.

HUGHES

(beat)

After this morning.

ELXA

(evenly)

After this morning.

He looks at her for a long time. He's a good cop. He knows exactly what she's doing. And he knows exactly what she's not doing.

She isn't firing him.

HUGHES

(quietly)

You know.

ELXA

(beat)

I know that everybody in this building gets one mistake, Deputy Chief. My father-in-law taught me

that. I believe he taught you.  
(beat)  
You've had yours.

The words sit on the desk between them.

Hughes picks up the folder. His hand is not quite steady.

HUGHES  
(finally)  
Yes, Chief.

ELXA  
Doyle's expecting you at nine. Be  
early. She likes early.

He stands. He goes to the door. He stops with his hand on  
the knob.

HUGHES  
(without turning)  
Harold Jackson made me a sergeant  
in 1985. He said I'd be Chief  
someday.

ELXA  
I know.

HUGHES  
(beat)  
He was wrong.

ELXA  
(beat)  
He wasn't wrong about what kind  
of cop you were, Warren.  
(beat)  
Be that one.

He goes. The door closes.

Elxa sits back. She lets out a long breath she's been  
holding since nine o'clock that morning.

She picks up her phone. She dials.

ELXA (CONT'D)  
(into phone)  
Harold. It's Elxa.  
(beat)  
No, sir. Nothing's wrong.  
(beat)

I just wanted to tell you. It was  
a closed door.

She listens. Her face softens.

ELXA (CONT'D)  
Yes, sir. I'll tell him.

CUT TO:

**21 INT. DEE'S KITCHEN – WEST END – THE BACK OFFICE –  
NIGHT**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 7:14 PM EST*

A cramped office behind the kitchen: invoices on a spike,  
a church calendar, a box of the new Hobart dishwasher's  
manuals, and Mama Dee's wedding photo in its silver frame  
on the desk.

Mama Dee sits in a swivel chair with the phone to her ear  
and her apron still on.

MAMA DEE  
(into phone)  
—same Nobody, Silas. That's what  
I'm telling you. Tall. White.  
Cap. Moves like a soldier. Your  
nephew ate with him Monday. Our  
people saw the same man drive the  
van in the park.

INTERCUT WITH:

**INT. MERRIWEATHER & SONS FUNERAL HOME – SILAS'S OFFICE –  
CONTINUOUS**

Silas at his rolltop, in a cardigan, his reading glasses  
on and the silver fork beside his blotter.

SILAS  
(slowly)  
The same man.

MAMA DEE  
The same man.

SILAS  
(beat)  
Otis found the car. Hertz.  
Airport. Paid cash, but they make  
you show a license. Otis's cousin

works the counter.  
(beat)  
The license was from New Zealand.

MAMA DEE  
New Zealand?

SILAS  
That's what the girl remembered.  
A long foreign license with a  
fern on it. Name she didn't  
remember. She said he was very  
polite and he tipped her twenty  
dollars for a map he didn't need.

MAMA DEE  
(beat)  
Polite.

SILAS  
Polite.

A pause on both ends.

MAMA DEE  
Silas. My boy says when we find  
him, we share. Like we said at  
the funeral.

SILAS  
I heard him at the funeral.  
(beat)  
Dolores. My nephew won't talk to  
me. He's talking to a stranger  
with a fern on his license. That  
stranger's teaching him  
something. I don't know what yet.

MAMA DEE  
Then keep him close.

SILAS  
I'm trying.  
(beat)  
Tell your boy Friday.

MAMA DEE  
He'll have a name Friday.

SILAS  
(beat, softening)  
Did you like the lilies?

MAMA DEE  
(beat, a smile she  
keeps out of her voice)  
They came in a hearse, Silas.

SILAS  
It's the only vehicle I trust.

MAMA DEE  
(laughing, finally)  
Goodnight, you old fool.

SILAS  
(smiling)  
Goodnight, Dolores.

They hang up. Mama Dee sits a moment. She looks at the wedding photograph. She touches the frame.

MAMA DEE  
(to the photograph)  
Don't look at me like that. He's  
just a friend.

CUT TO:

**22 INT. COLONY SQUARE — PARKING GARAGE — LEVEL 4 — NIGHT**  
*Thursday, January 13, 2005 — 8:04 PM EST*

A concrete parking deck in Midtown. Fluorescent tubes. A sign with an arrow: HOTEL ENTRANCE — LEVEL 1. Rows of cars.

A black Jaguar XJ8 turns in off the ramp and glides into a space near the elevators. The engine stops. Nobody gets out.

Thirty seconds pass.

A second car comes up the ramp. Not a Mercedes. A plain gray Ford Taurus, the kind of rental car nobody looks at twice. It parks three spaces from the Jaguar.

The Taurus door opens. A man gets out in a camel overcoat with the collar turned up, a Braves cap pulled low.

Robert Bullock.

He glances once around the deck. He walks to the Jaguar. The passenger door opens from the inside before he reaches it.

He doesn't get in. He leans down to the open door.

We can't hear what he says. We can see Camille's hand come out of the dark interior and rest against his cheek.

He closes his eyes.

Then the Jaguar's door closes. Camille gets out on the driver's side in a long black coat. They walk to the elevator. Not together. Six feet apart. Strangers who happen to be going the same way.

The elevator doors close.

On the ramp, the fluorescent light buzzes over the empty Taurus with its rental-company barcode on the back window.

CUT TO:

**23 INT. HARMONY'S TOWNHOUSE – LINDBERGH – FRONT DOOR – NIGHT**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 8:13 PM EST*

The doorbell rings.

Harmony, in sweatpants with her hair wrapped, looks through the peephole. She closes her eyes.

HARMONY  
(through the door)  
I said no more flowers.

AMOND (O.S.)  
No flowers.

She opens the door. Amond stands on the step in his camel coat. He's holding a stuffed giraffe, older and more worn than the one Lyric carries everywhere. One ear's been sewn back on.

HARMONY  
(beat)  
That's Other Raffe.

AMOND  
She asked for him on the phone last night. She said Raffe's lonely without Other Raffe. So.

He holds it out. Harmony takes it.

Behind her, from the living room, a delighted shriek.

LYRIC (O.S.)

OTHER RAFFE!

Lyric barrels down the hall in footie pajamas and seizes the second giraffe from her mother's hands. She runs back to the couch with one giraffe under each arm.

Harmony and Amond stand in the doorway. Neither moves.

AMOND

I didn't know.

HARMONY

(tired)

I know.

AMOND

(beat)

You know?

HARMONY

Esther said you probably didn't.  
And you sounded like you didn't.  
And you've never been a good  
liar. Two years of letters  
through lawyers, and you can't  
even lie in one of those.

AMOND

(a small, rueful smile)

My lawyer says that too.

HARMONY

Your lawyer's right.

AMOND

(beat)

My mother filed the hearing  
request last week. When you said  
"not yet." Then she changed her  
mind Tuesday, and it was too  
late.

(beat)

She's writing you a letter. An  
apology. For the desk.

(beat)

But she won't withdraw the  
petition.

HARMONY

(beat)

I know that too.

AMOND

And I'm not going to fight you in court, Harmony.

She looks up at him.

AMOND (CONT'D)

Whatever my mother does. Whatever her lawyer does. I'm not going to stand up in a courtroom and say one word against you.

(beat)

You're a good mother. I'll say that. That's all I'll say.

A long silence. Somewhere in the living room, Lyric is introducing Raffie to Other Raffie.

HARMONY

(quietly)

Why?

AMOND

(beat)

Because you are one.

Harmony looks at him. Her eyes are shining. She holds it together.

HARMONY

(finally)

Esther says let a judge say it.

AMOND

(beat)

Esther's smart.

HARMONY

Esther's terrifying.

AMOND

(a small smile)

That too.

HARMONY

(beat)

Goodnight, Amond.

AMOND

Goodnight.

She starts to close the door. Then she stops it halfway.

HARMONY  
(through the gap)  
The peonies are still alive.

AMOND  
(beat)  
Yeah?

HARMONY  
Don't send more.

She closes the door. Not a slam. Gently.

Amond stands on the step for a moment. He's grinning like an idiot.

He walks back to the Range Rover.

FADE OUT.



**ACT SIX****24 INT. DONOHUE MANOR — THE MASTER SUITE — NIGHT**

*Thursday, January 13, 2005 — 9:36 PM EST*

The grand master suite, a room Victor hasn't slept in for a week: a four-poster bed, a fire, silk walls, and photos of forty-five years of marriage on every surface.

Victor stands in the doorway in his pajamas and robe, holding his pillow under his arm like a boy at summer camp.

Joan sits up in the big bed in a silk nightgown, reading glasses on, reading a novel. She doesn't look up.

JOAN

Well, don't just stand there.

VICTOR

I'm waiting to be invited.

JOAN

(turning a page)

You're invited.

He crosses the room. He puts his pillow on his side of the bed. He sits down on the edge of the mattress and lets out a long, heartfelt breath.

VICTOR

(closing his eyes)

Lord. The Chesterfield is a torture device.

JOAN

Alexander bought it in 1952.

VICTOR

Alexander never slept on it.

JOAN

Alexander never needed to.

He laughs. He gets under the covers. Joan closes her book and takes off her reading glasses.

JOAN (CONT'D)

(quietly)

We're even.

VICTOR

(beat)

Are we?

JOAN

For the mayor. We're even.

(beat)

The next time you call a mayor  
about one of our grandchildren  
without telling me, it's fourteen  
nights.

VICTOR

(beat)

Understood.

She reaches over and turns off her lamp. The room goes  
gold with firelight.

They lie side by side in the dark for a moment.

VICTOR (CONT'D)

Joan.

JOAN

Hmm.

VICTOR

I asked Winston to pull the  
security tapes from the  
eighty-eighth floor. October  
fourteenth. The day "M." signed  
for the Harbour Point file.

JOAN

And?

VICTOR

The system tapes over itself  
every ninety days. October  
fourteenth is gone.

(beat)

Somebody knew that.

Joan turns her head on the pillow to look at him in the  
firelight.

JOAN

Victor.

VICTOR

I know.

JOAN  
Not tonight.

VICTOR  
(beat)  
Not tonight.

She reaches across and takes his hand under the covers. He holds on.

VICTOR (CONT'D)  
(barely)  
I missed you.

JOAN  
(eyes closing)  
I know. You snore in the library.  
Winston told me. He could hear it  
from the kitchen.

Victor laughs softly in the dark.

The fire burns. Forty-five years of photographs watch over them.

CUT TO:

**25 INT. THE BULLOCK PAVILION – LIVING ROOM – NIGHT**  
*Thursday, January 13, 2005 – 10:44 PM EST*

Marc's glass house on the bluff. The living room is dark except for the fire and the lights of the city far away through the glass. Alexander's pocket watch ticks on the coffee table.

Marc sits on the couch in a T-shirt and sweatpants with a legal pad on his knee: a list in his neat handwriting.  
HARBOUR POINT. KRUGER. TEDDY. COLONY SQ.? He crosses nothing out.

A knock at the glass door. Not the front door. The side door, by the terrace. Two soft knocks.

Marc looks up.

Arianna stands outside the glass in a long black coat, hands in her pockets. Her breath fogs.

He crosses the room and opens the door. The cold comes in with her.

MARC

You walked.

ARIANNA

Through the garden paths. I  
didn't want the gatehouse list to  
say my car was here again.

(beat)

Your great-grandmother reads it.

MARC

(beat)

She told me.

He closes the door behind her. She doesn't take off her  
coat. She stands in the middle of the dark living room, in  
front of the fire.

ARIANNA

She interviewed me today. Carla.  
At two o'clock.

MARC

I know. You texted.

ARIANNA

I didn't text you what she asked.

Marc waits.

ARIANNA (CONT'D)

Four questions. The same four for  
all two hundred and eleven people  
at the Hendersons'. That's how  
she does it. She makes it fair so  
nobody can say it wasn't.

(beat)

Question one. Was I there. I said  
yes.

(beat)

Question two. When did I leave  
and which way did I drive. I said  
a little after two. South on  
Northside. West on Paces.

(beat)

She said, "Toward the curve."

Marc says nothing. His face doesn't move.

ARIANNA (CONT'D)

Question three.

(beat, her voice very  
small)

"Between one-thirty and three o'clock that morning, did you see anyone walking on Northside Drive?"

A long silence. The watch ticks on the table.

ARIANNA (CONT'D)  
(barely)  
I said no.

MARC  
(quietly)  
Ari.

ARIANNA  
I looked her right in the eye and said no. And then I kept talking. I told her it was dark and there were no sidewalks and no streetlights and I was watching the road.  
(beat)  
I've cross-examined three hundred witnesses, Marc. I know what it means when somebody answers the question and then keeps talking.  
(beat)  
So does she. She wrote it down. I watched her write it down.

MARC  
(beat)  
What did she write?

ARIANNA  
I couldn't see. It was short.

She finally sits, on the edge of the coffee table, facing him. Her hands are shaking in her lap.

ARIANNA (CONT'D)  
And then at the door. Not a question. "Just making conversation."  
(beat)  
She asked what I was driving back then.

Marc goes absolutely still.

MARC  
(very quietly)

What did you tell her?

ARIANNA

The truth. A Volvo.

(beat)

She said, "Fathers do." Like it was nothing.

Marc stands up. He goes to the glass wall and looks out at the dark bluff, the river below, the far-off city.

His back is to her. She can't see his face. We can.

He's thinking. Fast.

ARIANNA (CONT'D)

(to his back)

I lied to her, Marc. To a woman who put his picture on my wall.

(beat)

I told Harmony I'd find him. I told her mother I'd bring him home. And today I sat in my office under his picture and lied to the only person in three years who's actually looking.

She breaks. Silently. Her face in her hands.

MARC

(not turning, low)

You didn't lie to her about the one thing she can check.

ARIANNA

(through her hands)

What?

MARC

(turning)

You told her the truth about the car. You told her you were driving. You told her which way you went. You told her you were at the party.

(beat)

The only thing you said that wasn't true is the one thing nobody alive can contradict.

ARIANNA

(looking up, stricken)

That's what makes it a lie, Marc.

MARC  
(beat)  
I know.

He crosses to her. He crouches in front of the coffee table so they're eye to eye. He takes her shaking hands.

MARC (CONT'D)  
(gently)  
Ari. Look at me.

She looks at him.

MARC (CONT'D)  
You are the best person I know.  
You're the only person in that courthouse who'd have reopened that file. You did it knowing what it might cost you.  
(beat)  
That's not a liar. That's a woman carrying something too heavy to carry alone.

ARIANNA  
(barely)  
Then help me carry it.

MARC  
I've been carrying it with you for three years.

ARIANNA  
Not like this. Not with her looking.

A long beat. The fire crackles. The watch ticks.

Something changes in Marc's face. The tenderness doesn't leave, but something colder rises up behind it, steady and clear.

Sovereign.

MARC  
(very quietly)  
Then tell me everything about Carla Mims.

ARIANNA  
(beat)  
Marc.

MARC

Where she lives. Who she's  
married to. What she drives. What  
church she goes to. Who she calls  
when she's stuck. How she takes  
her coffee.

(beat)

Everything.

ARIANNA

(pulling her hands  
back, frightened now)

Marc. She's a good woman. She's  
doing her job.

MARC

(evenly)

I know she is.

ARIANNA

You can't—

MARC

I'm not going to hurt her, Ari.

(beat)

I'm going to understand her.

Arianna stares at him. The man she's known since they were  
children, crouched in front of her in a T-shirt, holding  
her hands. And the other one, looking out through his  
eyes.

ARIANNA

(barely)

What's the difference?

Marc doesn't answer.

HOLD on the two of them in the firelight. On the coffee  
table beside them, Alexander's watch keeps ticking.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE #0009

## NEXT ON BEYOND THE KINGDOM...

- In the Ghost Room at 1 AM, KEISHA breaks into a stone-cutting shop's order book in Johannesburg: "Two thousand discs. Six crests. Shipped to Savannah."
- On the Savannah waterfront, ROMAN reads a customs filing for a container from Durban. The attorney of record is BULLOCK & ASSOCIATES. MARC: "That's my father's firm."
- In an empty Midtown parking garage at 11:48 PM, MARTIN slides a thick envelope across the hood of a car to a tall man in a cap. "Again. Bigger." The man tips his cap. "Someone they can't ignore."

FADE TO BLACK.